



Attach value to your data

1. What form or type of data would you define as an asset?

The very step in making your own data protection plan is to sit down and list down all the data that you have on online platforms and where it is. Then, for good measure, you can go ahead and make another addition to this list, elucidating who has access to your data, which is placed all over the internet. Segregate the assets from the common data, which you usually would not care about. Either delete such information or dedicate a space to such data and store it there. There is no point in leaving it out there, loose and up for grabs, because who knows who might use what in what way. It is always better to be safe than sorry. We all know that.

2. Know and understand the adversaries

Before taking any step with your data, it is important to make sure to know who you are up against. Say, if in your region, ransomware has been all the rage and you know that you may have taken some data from a device that was later subjected to ransomware. You need to make sure that they are on the list of potential threats to your data. Other institutions such as government agencies, individuals and corporations can also be the ones whom if you feel a sense of insecurity from, can be included in your list. This step is totally subjective and would vary from individual to individual, depending upon the data that you deal with. As quoted on the SSD website, “Depending on who your adversaries are, under some circumstances this list might be something you want to destroy after you’re done security planning.”